



CARGO CONVOY CRM

Comprehensive User Manual & Technical Documentation

Cargo Convoy Inc

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Built with Laravel 12 | PHP 8.4

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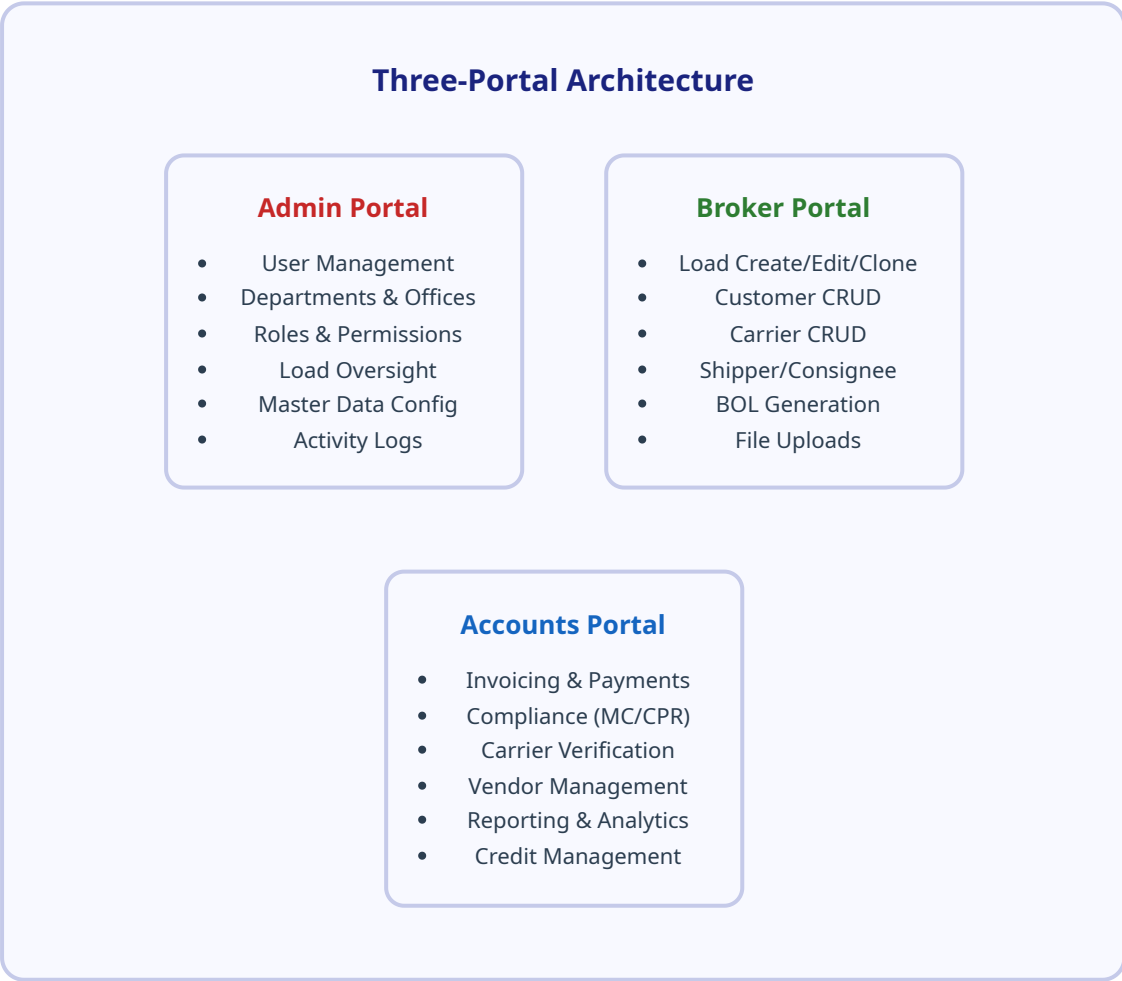
1. System Overview & Architecture

1.1 What is Cargo Convoy CRM?

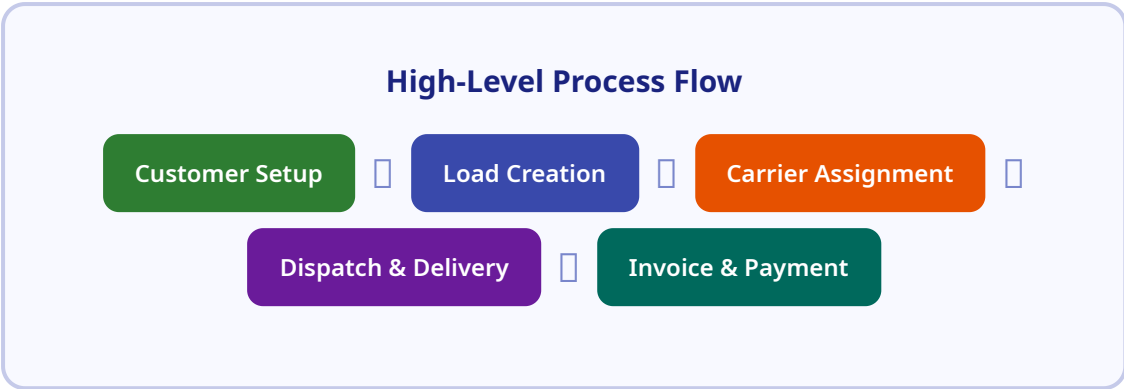
Cargo Convoy CRM is a comprehensive freight brokerage management system designed for **Cargo Convoy Inc.** It manages the complete lifecycle of freight loads from creation to payment, including customer relationships, carrier management, invoicing, compliance checks, and document handling.

Technology Stack: Laravel 11 (PHP 8.4) | MySQL Database | Blade Templates | Bootstrap 5 | jQuery | Dompdf for PDF generation | PhpSpreadsheet for Excel exports

1.2 System Architecture Diagram



1.3 Application Flow Overview



2. User Roles & Access Control

2.1 Role Hierarchy



2.2 Role Access Matrix

Role Group	Role IDs	Portal Access	Landing Page
Admin	1, 2, 3, 22	Admin + Broker + Account	/admin/admin_home
Accounting	7, 8, 9, 24	Account + Broker	/account/accounting
Vendor/AP	4, 5, 6	Account + Broker	/account/vendor-system
Compliance	10, 11, 12	Account + Broker	/account/compliance
Reporting	13-18	Account + Broker	/account/reporting
Manager	19	Broker	/broker/load
Team Leader	20	Broker	/broker/load

Agent/Broker	21	Broker	/broker/load
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2.3 Middleware Access Control

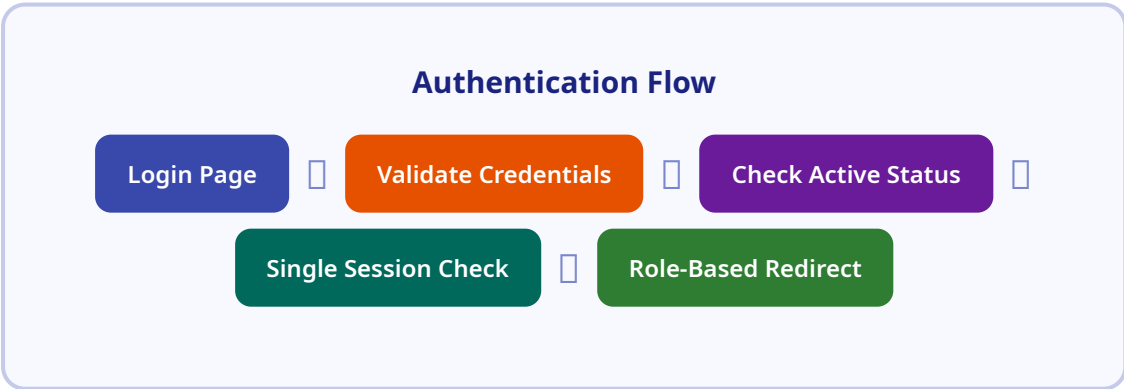
```
// EnsureUserIsAuthenticated.php - URL Segment Permission
if (in_array($role_id, $accounts)) {
    $urls = ['account', 'broker', 'file', 'files', 'remaing'];
} elseif (in_array($role_id, $broker)) {
    $urls = ['broker', 'file', 'files', 'remaing'];
} elseif (in_array($role_id, $admin)) {
    $urls = ['admin', 'broker', 'account', 'file', 'files', 'remaing'];
}
// If user accesses unauthorized URL segment -> 404
```

2.4 Data Visibility Rules

- Admins (Roles 1,2,3):** See ALL data across all users
- Managers (Role 19):** See data of team leaders under them + agents under those TLs
- Team Leaders (Role 20):** See data of agents under them
- Agents (Role 21):** See only their own data

3. Authentication & Login Flow

3.1 Login Process Flowchart



3.2 Key Security Features

- 1 Single Session Enforcement:** Only one active session per user. If user is already logged in from another device, login is blocked (unless session expired > 1 minute).

- 2

Active Status Check: Only users with status = "active" can login. Inactive accounts are blocked.
- 3

Session Management: Old sessions are cleared on new login. LogoutOtherDevices is enforced.
- 4

Activity Logging: Every login/logout is recorded with username, IP, and timestamp.

3.3 Password Management

Users can change their password from the Profile section. Admins can reset passwords for any user via the admin panel.

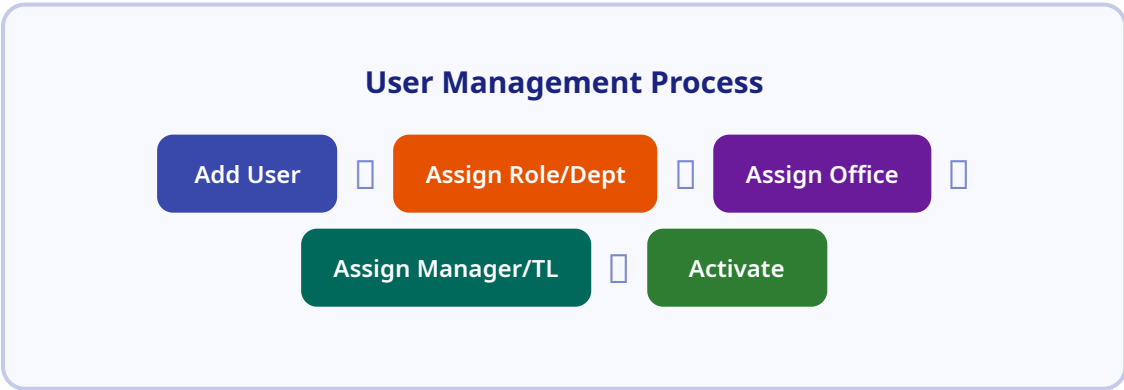
```
// Password change requires current password verification
Route::post('broker/change-password', [AdminController::class, 'update_password']);
Route::post('admin/admin-update-password/{id}', [AdminController::class,
'admin_update_password']);
```

4. Admin Panel Module

4.1 Admin Dashboard

The admin dashboard provides a comprehensive overview of all loads across the system with tabs for different statuses. Admins can filter by Office, Manager, Team Leader, and Agent.

4.2 User Management



Feature	Description	Route
Create User	Add new user with role, department, office, manager, TL assignment	POST admin/create-user

Update Status	Activate/Deactivate user accounts	POST admin/update-status
Reset Password	Admin can reset any user's password	POST admin/admin-update-password/{id}
View Users	Separate views for Broker, Account, and Admin users	GET admin/broker-users

4.3 Organization Structure Management

Entity	Operations	Purpose
Departments	CRUD	Broker (3), Account (2), Admin (1), IT (6,7)
Offices	CRUD	Physical office locations
Managers	CRUD	Link users as managers within offices/departments
Team Leaders	CRUD	Link users as TLs under managers

4.4 Master Data Configuration

Master Data	Examples
Equipment Types	Dry Van, Flatbed, Reefer, etc.
Shipment Types	FTL, LTL, TONU, etc.
Status Types	Open, Delivered, Completed, etc.
Countries & States	Geographic data for address forms
IP Configuration	IP whitelist for security

4.5 All Data View

Admins have access to a consolidated "All Data" view with tabs for Customers, Carriers, Shippers, Consignees, and Loads with full search capability.

5. Broker Module

5.1 Broker Dashboard

The Broker portal is the primary workspace for freight brokers/agents. After login, brokers land on the Load Management page where they can manage their loads through different status tabs.

5.2 Broker Module Features

Load Management

- Create New Load
- Edit Load
- Clone Load
- Change Status
- Search & Filter

Customer Management

- Add Customer
- Edit Customer
- Credit Monitoring
- Remittance Upload

Carrier Management

- My Carriers
- All Carriers
- Add/Edit Carrier
- MC/DOT Search

Shipper/Consignee

- Add Shipper
- Add Consignee
- Cross-reference
- Auto-fill in Loads

5.3 Navigation Structure

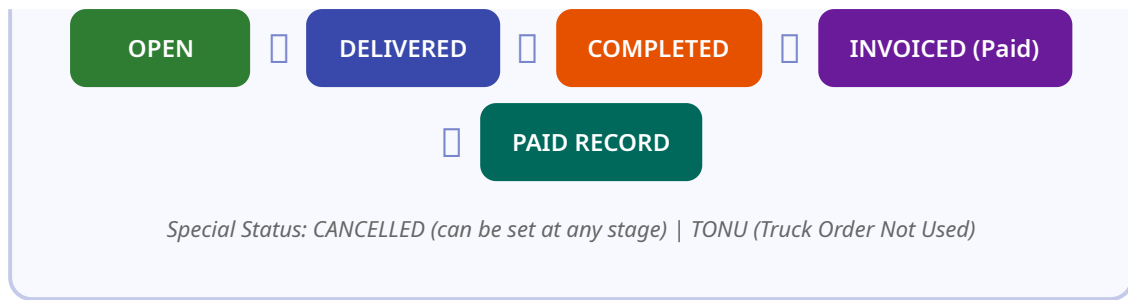
Broker Portal URLs:

/broker/load	- Load listing (main page)
/broker/load-create	- Create new load
/broker/edit-load/{id}	- Edit existing load
/broker/clone/load/{id}	- Clone existing load
/broker/customer	- Customer management
/broker/carrier	- Carrier management
/broker/shipper	- Shipper management
/broker/Consignee	- Consignee management
/broker/profile	- User profile settings

6. Load Management (Core Module)

6.1 Load Lifecycle Flowchart

Load Status Workflow



6.2 Load Creation Process

- 1 **Select Customer (Bill To):** Choose an approved customer. System validates credit limit before allowing creation.
- 2 **Set Load Type:** OTR (Over The Road) or DRAYAGE. Type determines rate field editability.
- 3 **Add Shipper(s):** Multiple shippers supported. Select from saved shippers or enter new. Includes location, appointment date/time, commodity details.
- 4 **Add Consignee(s):** Multiple consignees with delivery appointments. Delivery date must be after pickup date.
- 5 **Assign Carrier:** Search by name, MC#, or DOT#. Auto-fills carrier details. System validates carrier exists in database.
- 6 **Set Rates:** Customer rate + FSC + other charges = Final Rate. Carrier fee must not exceed customer final rate.
- 7 **Credit Validation:** System checks if new load amount would exceed customer's assigned credit limit.

6.3 Credit Limit Validation

```
// Credit limit check during load creation
$assignedCreditLimit = $customer->adv_customer_credit_limit;
$totalLoadCreationAmount = Load::where('customer_id', $customerId)
->where('load_status', '!=', 'Cancelled')
->sum('shipper_load_final_rate');
$newTotal = $totalLoadCreationAmount + $loadAmount;

if ($newTotal > $assignedCreditLimit) {
    return error("Cannot create load. Available credit exceeded.");
}
```

6.4 Load Tabs & Filtering

Tab	Filter Criteria	Description
-----	-----------------	-------------

All Loads	No filter	Shows all loads (paginated 50/page)
Open	load_status = 'Open'	Active loads awaiting dispatch
Delivered	load_status = 'Delivered'	Loads confirmed delivered
Complete	load_status = 'Completed' AND no invoice	Ready for invoicing
Invoiced	invoice_status = 'Paid'	Invoice generated/sent
Paid	invoice_status = 'Paid Record'	Payment received

6.5 Load Clone Feature

Brokers can clone an existing load to quickly create similar shipments. The clone copies all shipper/consignee info, customer, carrier, and other details but resets rates to 0 and status to "Open".

6.6 Rate Calculation Logic

Rate Calculation Formula

Customer Side:

Customer Rate + (FSC% x Customer Rate) + Other Charges = **Shipper Final Rate**

Carrier Side:

Carrier Fee + (Billing FSC% x Carrier Fee) + Other Charges = **Final Carrier Fee**

Profit Margin: Shipper Final Rate - Final Carrier Fee = **Margin**

7. Customer Management

7.1 Customer Lifecycle

Customer Approval Workflow

Broker Creates Customer



Status: Not Approved



Admin/Account Reviews



Status: Approved

Important: Only approved customers can be selected when creating loads. The system enforces this validation at both form and controller level.

7.2 Customer Data Fields

Section	Fields
Basic Info	Name, MC/FF Type & Number, Corporation Type, Status
Address	Street, Country, State, City, ZIP
Billing Address	Separate billing address fields
Contacts	Primary contact, telephone, email, secondary contact, billing email
Advanced	Currency, Credit Limit, Payment Terms, Factoring Company, Website
Documents	File uploads (multiple), Remittance files

7.3 Credit Limit System

```
// Credit Summary Calculation (helpers.php)
function calculate_customer_credit_summary($customer, $assignedCreditLimit, $loadCreateAmount,
$receivingAmount) {
    $usedAmount = max(0, $loadCreateAmount - $receivingAmount);
    $remainingCredit = max(0, $assignedCreditLimit - $loadCreateAmount);
    return ['assigned_credit_limit', 'used_amount', 'remaining_credit'];
}
```

7.4 Customer Approval Form

Brokers can submit a Customer Approval Form which goes through the admin/account team for review. Once approved, the credit limit is assigned and the customer becomes available for load creation.

7.5 Remittance Management

Both Brokers and Account teams can upload remittance files (PDFs, images) against customers. Files are tagged with timestamps and notes, and can be filtered by date range.

8. Carrier Management

8.1 Carrier Data Structure

Carrier (External) Entity

Identification: Carrier Name, MC/FF Number, DOT Number

Address: Country, State, City, ZIP

Contact: Contact Name, Email, Telephone, Extension, Fax

Business: Payment Terms, Factoring Company, Load Type, Corporation

Status: Active/Blacklisted/Blocked

Documents: File uploads (W9, Insurance, Authority Letter)

8.2 Carrier Views

View	Description	Access
My Carriers	Carriers added by the logged-in broker	Agent's own
All Carriers	All carriers in the system	Searchable by all

8.3 Carrier Validation

Unique MC#: System enforces unique MC numbers. Duplicate MC# is rejected.

Unique DOT#: DOT numbers must also be unique across all carriers.

Load Assignment: When assigning a carrier to a load, the system verifies the carrier exists in the database.

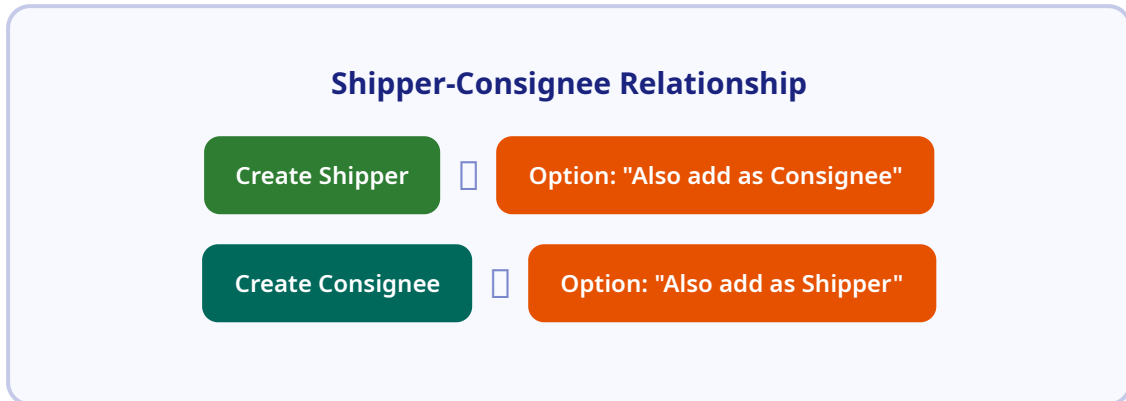
8.4 Carrier Auto-Suggest in Load Form

When typing carrier name, MC#, or DOT# in the load form, the system provides live suggestions via AJAX. Selecting a suggestion auto-fills all carrier fields.

```
// Carrier suggestion endpoint
Route::post('broker/fetch-carrier-suggestions', [LoadController::class, 'fetchCarrierSuggestions']);
// Returns: id, carrier_name, mcNumber, dotNumber, phone
```

9. Shipper & Consignee Management

9.1 Shipper/Consignee Cross-Reference



9.2 Data Fields

Field	Shipper	Consignee
Name	shipper_name	consignee_name
Address	Full address (country/state/city/zip)	Full address
Contact	Name, email, phone, ext, fax	Name, email, phone, ext, fax
Operations	Hours, appointments, intersections	Hours, appointments, intersections
Notes	Shipping notes, internal notes	Shipping notes, internal notes

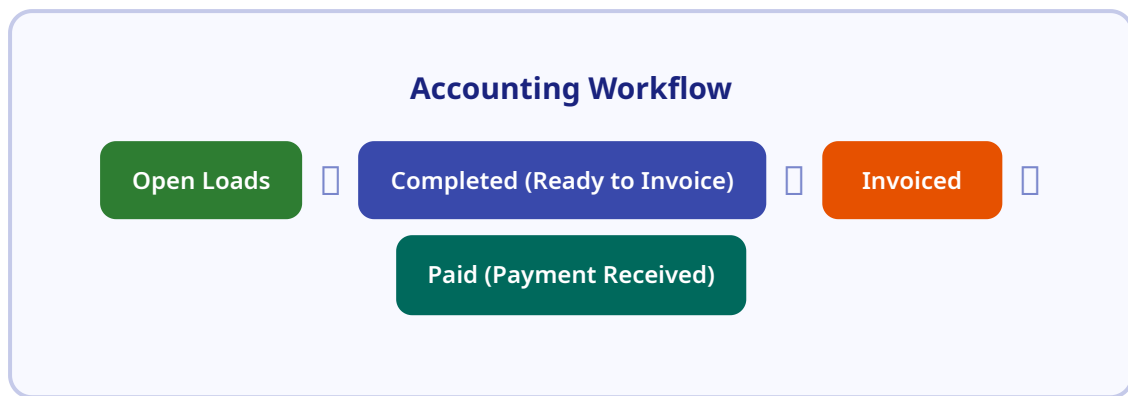
9.3 Usage in Load Creation

When creating or editing a load, brokers can select from their saved shippers and consignees. The system auto-fills the address fields. Multiple shipper/consignee stops are supported (up to 15).

```
// Auto-fill shipper details in load form
Route::get('broker/fetch-shipper-details', [LoadController::class, 'fetchShipperDetails']);
Route::get('broker/fetch-consignee-details', [LoadController::class, 'fetchConsigneeDetails']);
```

10. Accounting & Invoicing

10.1 Accounting Dashboard Tabs



10.2 Invoice Generation

- 1 **Mark as Invoiced:** Account team changes invoice_status to 'Paid' (meaning invoiced to customer)
- 2 **Generate Invoice PDF:** System generates invoice with load details, customer info, rates
- 3 **Email Invoice:** Send invoice via email with attachments (merged PDF of all documents)
- 4 **Record Payment:** Update receiving_amount when payment is received
- 5 **Mark as Paid Record:** Final status when fully paid

10.3 Multi-Load Invoicing

The system supports generating a single invoice for multiple loads (PI - Proforma Invoice). Account team enters comma-separated load numbers to generate a combined invoice.

```
// Multi-load invoice generation
Route::Post('account/loads-pi', [AccountController::class, 'loadspi']);
Route::Post('account/loads-multipal-invoice', [AccountController::class, 'loadsMultipalInvoice']);
```

10.4 Carrier Payment Management

Feature	Description
Quick Pay	Mark carrier for expedited payment
Payment Method	Set payment method (ACH, Check, Zelle)
Ready to Pay	Flag load as ready for carrier payment

Carrier Due Date	Set carrier payment due date
Mark as Paid	Record carrier payment completion
Upload Documents	Attach carrier invoices and receipts

10.5 Vendor Management System

The Vendor System provides a consolidated view of all loads with carrier payment status, internal notes, and quick actions for the accounts payable team.

10.6 AR Aging Close (New)

New Feature: Account team can now close aging records directly from the Paid tab when payments are fully reconciled.

- 1 View Aging:** See aging days (days since invoice) for each paid load
- 2 Review Payment:** Check excess/remaining amounts after partial payments
- 3 Close Aging:** Click "Close" to mark the aging record as reconciled

Route: POST /account/update-ar-aging-close

10.7 All Load Status AR View (New)

A comprehensive dashboard showing **all loads across all statuses** for the AR team. Includes:

Feature	Description
All Status Tabs	View Open, Delivered, Completed, Invoiced, Paid all in one page
Advanced Filters	Filter by office, agent, date range, customer
Excess/Remaining	Track overpayment and underpayment per load
Bulk Actions	Process multiple loads at once

Route: GET /account/all-status-loads

10.8 Custom Invoice Subject (New)

Account team can now customize the email subject line when sending invoices. The default format is:

Invoice For Load #{load_no} ({invoice_no}) REF #{reference_no}

Users can edit this before sending, or leave it as the default.

10.9 Credit Limit Log Export (New)

Export the complete credit limit change history for all customers as an Excel spreadsheet. Useful for auditing credit changes over time.

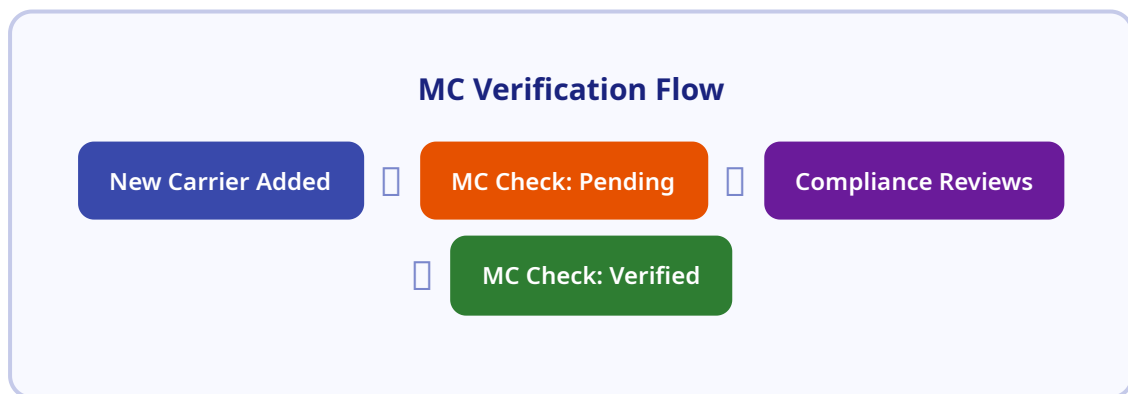
Route: GET /account/customers/export-credit-limit-log

11. Compliance Module

11.1 Compliance Overview

The compliance module ensures all carriers meet regulatory requirements before loads can be dispatched. It covers MC (Motor Carrier) checks and CPR (Carrier Performance Review) checks.

11.2 MC Check Process



11.3 CPR (Carrier Performance Review) Check

Each load can have a CPR status that indicates whether the carrier assignment has been reviewed and approved by compliance.

Status	Meaning
--------	---------

Not Approved	Default - carrier assignment not yet reviewed
Verified	Carrier approved for this load
Not Verified	Carrier rejected - needs replacement

11.4 Carrier Verification

Detailed carrier verification includes factoring company verification, bank document uploads, and insurance validation.

```
Route::get('account/carrier-verification', [AccountController::class, 'carrier_verification']);
Route::post('account/carrier-verification/save', [AccountController::class, 'carrier_verification_save']);
```

11.5 Carrier Block/Unblock

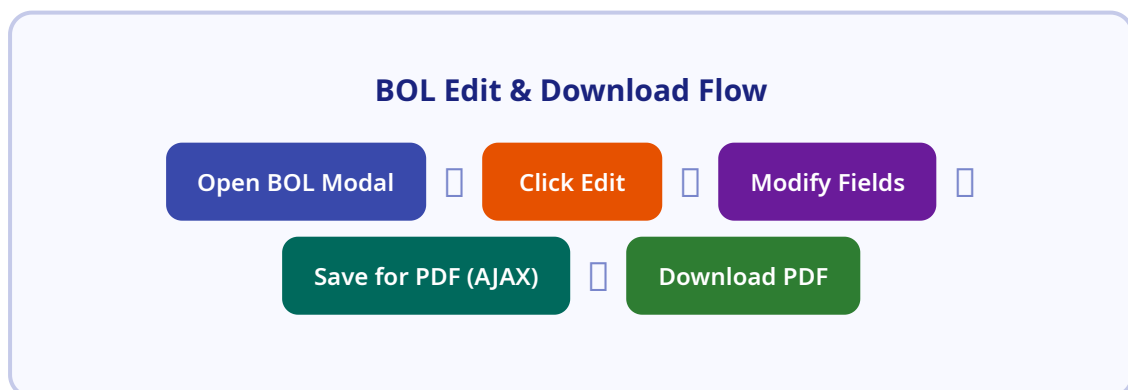
Compliance team can block carriers who fail compliance checks. Blocked carriers cannot be assigned to new loads.

12. Bill of Lading (BOL)

12.1 BOL Feature Overview

The Bill of Lading module allows brokers to generate, edit, and download BOL documents as PDFs. Edited data is saved and persists for future downloads.

12.2 BOL Workflow



12.3 BOL Document Sections

Section	Content
Header	Company logo, name, address, phone
Load Info	Load Number, BOL Number, Ship Date, Delivery Date
Shipper	Shipper name(s) and address(es)
Consignee	Consignee name(s) and address(es)
3rd Party Billing	Third-party billing information
Transportation Co.	MC#, Carrier Name
Freight Table	Pieces, Description, Weight, Type, NMFC, HM, Class
Notes & COD	Notes, COD Amount, COD Fee, Declared Value
Signatures	Shipper, Carrier, Consignee signatures with dates

12.4 Technical Implementation

```
// Save BOL edit data (AJAX POST)
Route::post('/broker/load/{id}/bol/save', [LoadController::class, 'saveBolEditData']);

// Download BOL PDF (GET - reads from saved bol_edit_data)
Route::get('/broker/load/{id}/bol/pdf', [LoadController::class, 'generateBolPdf']);

// PDF generated using Dompdf library with 'letter' paper size
```

13. Reporting & Analytics

13.1 Report Types



Credit/Limit Report

Load Completed Log

13.2 Report Details

Report	Key Metrics	Export
Carrier Report	Total revenue per carrier, load count, open/delivered/completed breakdown	Excel
Customer Report	Revenue per customer, margin, credit limit usage	Excel
Customer Detail	Full customer listing with all details	Excel
Dispatcher Report	Revenue per agent, carrier fees, margins, load counts	Excel
Load Report	Individual load details with user info	Excel
Sales Rep Report	Shipper rates vs carrier fees per agent	Excel
Aging Report	Invoice aging (days since invoice date)	Excel
Credit/Limit Report	Customer credit limits and remaining credit	Excel

13.3 Sales Dashboard Chart

The reporting module includes an interactive chart showing daily revenue trends with filters for:

- **Date Range:** Custom start and end dates (default: last 7 days)
- **Office:** Filter by office location
- **Agent:** Filter by specific agent

Chart displays: Shipper Rates (revenue), Carrier Fees (cost), and Margin (profit) by date.

13.4 Export Functionality

All reports support Excel export using PhpSpreadsheet library. PDF exports are available for specific reports using Dompdf.

```
// Example: Excel export routes
Route::get('account/CarrierReportingExcel', [AccountController::class, 'CarrierReportingExcel']);
Route::get('account/customerReportingExcel', [AccountController::class, 'customerReportingExcel']);
Route::get('account/dispatcherReportingExcel', [AccountController::class,
```

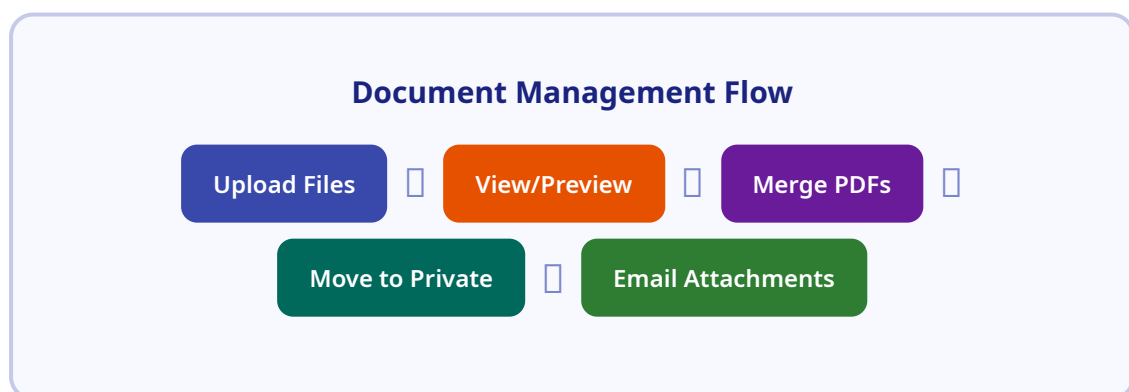
```
'dispatcherReportingExcel']);
Route::get('account/agingReportingExcel', [AccountController::class, 'agingReportingExcel']);
```

14. Document Management & File Uploads

14.1 Load Document Types

Document Type	Field Name	Purpose
Carrier Rate Confirmation	carrer_rate_cnfrm_doc	Signed rate agreement with carrier
Proof of Delivery (POD)	pod_doc	Delivery confirmation document
Shipper Rate Approval	shipper_rate_approval_doc	Customer rate approval
Carrier Invoice	carrier_invoice_doc	Carrier's invoice for payment
Delivery Order (DO)	do	Original delivery order document
Optional Documents	optional_docs	Any additional supporting documents

14.2 File Operations



14.3 PDF Merge Feature

Multiple uploaded documents (PDFs and images) can be merged into a single PDF per load. This merged file is used for emailing invoices with all supporting documents.

```
// Merge files endpoint
Route::post('files/merge-files', [FilesUploadController::class, 'mergeFiles']);
// Uses TCPDF + FPDF for PDF merging
// Images (jpg, png, gif) are converted to PDF before merging
```

14.4 File Storage Structure

```
public/uploads/
|-- Load-files/{load_number}-{customer_id}/ (Public load documents)
|-- delivery-order/{load_id}/ (Private delivery orders)
|-- carrier/ (Carrier documents)
|-- customers/{customer_name}/ (Customer files)
|-- remittances/ (Remittance files)
|-- mergedfiles/ (Merged PDFs)
```

15. Email System

15.1 Invoice Email

The system sends invoice emails to customers with all relevant documents attached. Multiple recipients (TO and CC) are supported.

15.2 Email Process

- 1 **Select Documents:** Choose which load documents to attach (Rate Con, POD, Invoice, etc.)
- 2 **Set Recipients:** Enter email addresses (comma-separated for multiple). Optional CC field.
- 3 **Auto-Merge:** If multiple files selected, system merges them into one PDF attachment.
- 4 **Send:** Email sent via SMTP with professional template including load#, invoice#, ref#.

15.3 Email Template

```
Subject: Invoice For Load #{load_no} (#{invoice_no}) REF #{reference_no}
From: ar@cargoconvoy.co (Cargoconvoy)
Reply-To: ar@cargoconvoy.co
```

```
Body:
"Greetings!
```

Kindly find the attached invoice for load #{load_no} ({invoice_no}) Ref #{ref_no}

Thanks & Regards
{Username}
Accounts Receivable
Cargo Convoy Inc
Mailing Address: 7119, Pennsylvania Ave, Upper Darby, PA - 19082
MC - 01512751 | DOT - 4014885"

15.4 Security

Attachment Security: Only files from authorized directories (uploads/delivery-order and uploads/) can be attached. The system validates file paths to prevent arbitrary file access.

16. Database Schema

16.1 Core Tables

Table	Purpose	Key Relationships
users	All system users	belongs_to: role, department, office, manager, team_leader
loads	Core freight loads	belongs_to: user, customer, carrier(external)
customers	Customer entities	belongs_to: user; has_many: loads
externals	Carriers	belongs_to: user; has_many: loads
shippers	Shipper locations	belongs_to: user
consignees	Consignee locations	belongs_to: user
roles	User roles	has_many: role_has_permissions
permissions	System permissions	belongs_to: department
role_has_permissions	Role-permission mapping	belongs_to: role, permission
departments	Organization departments	has_many: users

offices	Office locations	has_many: users
mangers	Manager assignments	belongs_to: user, office, department
team_leaders	Team leader assignments	belongs_to: manager
logs	Activity audit trail	records all CRUD operations
carrier_verification	Carrier compliance data	belongs_to: load
load_payments	Payment records	belongs_to: load

16.2 Loads Table - Key Columns

Column Group	Fields
Identity	id, load_number, user_id, customer_id, carrier_id
Status	load_status, invoice_status, cpr_check
Customer Rates	load_shipper_rate, load_fsc_rate, shipper_load_final_rate
Carrier Rates	load_carrier_fee, load_billing_fsc_rate, load_final_carrier_fee
Shipper (JSON)	load_shipper, load_shipper_location, load_shipper_appointment
Consignee (JSON)	load_consignee, load_consignee_location, load_consignee_appointment
Invoice	invoice_number, invoice_date, invoice_status, receiving_amount
Documents	public_file, load_delivery_do_file, carrierDoc
BOL	bol_edit_data (JSON - saved BOL edits)

17. API Routes & Endpoints

17.1 Admin Routes

Method	Endpoint	Purpose
GET	/admin/admin_home	Admin dashboard with all loads

GET	/admin/broker-users	List broker users
POST	/admin/create-user	Create new user
POST	/admin/update-status	Activate/deactivate user
GET	/admin/department	Department management
GET	/admin/office	Office management
GET	/admin/manager	Manager management
GET	/admin/team_leader	Team leader management
GET	/admin/roles	Roles & permissions
GET	/admin/all_data	Consolidated data view
GET	/admin/activity_logs	System activity logs

17.2 Broker Routes

Method	Endpoint	Purpose
GET	/broker/load	Load listing with tabs
POST	/broker/load-create	Create new load
GET	/broker/edit-load/{id}	Edit load form
POST	/broker/load/update/{id}	Update load
GET	/broker/clone/load/{id}	Clone load
GET	/broker/load/{id}/bol/pdf	Download BOL PDF
POST	/broker/load/{id}/bol/save	Save BOL edit data
GET	/broker/customer	Customer list
POST	/broker/customer/create	Create customer
GET	/broker/carrier	Carrier list
POST	/broker/create/carrier	Create carrier
GET	/broker/shipper	Shipper list
GET	/broker/Consignee	Consignee list

17.3 Account Routes

Method	Endpoint	Purpose
GET	/account/accounting	Accounting dashboard
GET	/account/compliance	Compliance dashboard
GET	/account/reporting	Reports & analytics
GET	/account/vendor-system	Vendor management
GET	/account/carrier-verification	Carrier verification
POST	/account/mc-chcek	MC check update
POST	/account/cpr-check	CPR check update
POST	/account/update-invoice-status/{id}	Mark as invoiced
POST	/account/send-mail	Send invoice email
GET	/account/credit	Credit management
POST	/account/update-ar-aging-close	Close AR aging record
GET	/account/all-status-loads	All Load Status AR view
GET	/account/customers/export-credit-limit-log	Export credit limit log to Excel

17.4 Activity Logging

```
// Every significant action is logged via helpers.php
addToLog($customer_id, $load_id, $subject, $old_data, $new_data);

// Log record contains:
// - user_name, user_id, user_email
// - IP address, full URL
// - old_json (before state), new_json (after state)
// - message (human-readable description)
```

Cargo Convoy CRM - User Manual

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Generated from codebase branch: devN | Routes: 303 | Views: 124